

or (Power)

for even the same family of processors. For starters, consider this: a motherboard that supports the Pentium 4, 1.8 GHz may not support the Pentium 4, 2 GHz and above.

Buying a processor earlier used to be fairly simple. There was a fast version and then there was an even faster version of a similar processor. You would get increased performance every step of the way.

Things are no longer that simple. Though modern day processors can be clocked at 2 GHz or more, there is a lot more to performance than the clock speed. Today we find a wide variety of

processors with variations in architecture, supporting technologies, pricing structures and, most importantly, real-world performance.

Confused already? That's why we tested 15 of the latest processors available in the market and untangled the intricacies of getting the maximum performance out of the processor you already have.

Synthetically the fastest

Ideally, depending on your requirements, you would want the fastest processor. But



Intel Pentium III 800 MHz



AMD Duron 1.1 GHz



Intel Pentium 4 1.5 GHz



Intel Pentium 4 1.7 GHz



Intel Pentium 4 2 GHz



Intel Pentium III 700 MHz



AMD Athlon 1.4 GHz



Intel Pentium III 1.13 GHz